

THE ULTIMATE **SELF DISCIPLINE** HACK



The day you walk into CIA's covert training facility, everything is taken from you.

You give up your phone, your ID, your personal items, even your wedding ring. They already know who you are – they already know you are capable.

And they already know you will see it through to the end.

**CIA trains you to make the best choice,
instead of always taking the easy choice.**

They train you to lean into courage instead of getting hijacked by fear. And they train you to combat temptation...

...and win.

Temptation drains your energy, your emotions, and your hope.

You are surrounded by temptation every day.

- You are tempted by distractions.
- You are tempted to quit trying.
- You are tempted to believe that you will not achieve what you want to achieve.

At CIA's elite covert training facility, a place operators lovingly call 'The Farm', you learn through experience.

When you train using 'experiential learning,' you make knowledge and behavior permanent by applying the concepts you learn right away. You learn a concept, then apply it. Build on that knowledge with a new concept, and apply it. Over and over.

This is the same proven process I use to help people take control and live the life they've always wanted.

Today, you learn the secrets that make spies, special operators, and elite action units successful.

And it all starts with elite self-discipline.

**27% of people say they lack the self-discipline to achieve
their personal and professional goals.**

Self-discipline is misunderstood.

Some people think it's a personality trait. Others think it is a learned skill. Neither is fully correct.

Self-discipline is the conscious practice of exercising subconscious 'willpower.'

To understand self-discipline, we must first understand willpower.

Willpower is your ability to resist the things that tempt you.

It is a natural human cognitive skill and everyone is born with it.

But even though we are all born with willpower, we do not have equal amounts of willpower as adults. Your willpower evolves and develops according to your experiences.

Willpower is a limited resource. Once it is spent, you 'lose' your will.

And you already know what that looks like:

- You resist the box of donuts when you arrive in the office at 8am, but break down and eat one at 2pm in the afternoon.
- You get excited during lunch-hour thinking about playing with your kids at home, but after you get home you just want to be left alone.
- You daydream about the adventures you want to take, but when the weekend finally comes you just sit at home.

These are examples of your willpower getting spent. Those with more willpower can last longer, but we all feel ourselves running low by the end of each day.

The average person spends 4 hours a day resisting temptations and depleting their willpower.

Whether you are a dieter resisting Boston Cream or a smoker trying to quit – resistance is taxing.

The energy you spend exercising your will is real, just like the energy you spend walking or running. And like jogging or hiking, you will get tired and eventually run out of energy.

When you deplete your willpower, the pleasure and pain receptors in your brain become more sensitive.

First thing in the morning, your willpower reserves are full. You can resist unhealthy food, annoying people, and emotional spikes with ease.

But after a full day of work, your willpower is drained.

That's why radio commercials give you a headache on your commute home from work but not on your commute into work – your pain receptors are more sensitive to noise/pitch when you run out of willpower.

It's also why beer tastes best at 6pm after a hard day of work – your pleasure receptors are turned up from spent willpower.

Just like any other muscle, your willpower can be increased; it can recover, grow, and gain capacity/strength.

It just takes exercise.

And like growing muscles, the key to success is in recovery. If you let yourself run out of willpower, it cannot grow or increase. Instead, you have to spend it wisely and give yourself space to recover your willpower before you deplete it.

The way you achieve self-discipline is by increasing your capacity for willpower.

Willpower allows you to resist temptation; to persevere; to endure discomfort, pain, and fear.

Resisting temptation allows you to make the best decisions – the decisions you want to make instead of the decisions you 'happen' to make.

Self-discipline is the act of making the best decisions consistently, without caving-in to temptation.

Until you increase your willpower, self-discipline cannot be achieved.

Imagine you are put in a waiting room with a plate of fresh baked cookies and a plate of cut celery. You are told you can only eat the celery while you wait.

Then you are given a challenging puzzle to solve. How long will your willpower resist the temptation to give up on finishing the puzzle? Not long at all.

By spending your willpower resisting the temptation of the cookies, you've depleted your willpower to try solving the puzzle.

This test has been conducted on children and adults using everything from marsh-

mallows to radishes. And for the last 50 years, the conclusion has remained consistent:

Willpower is a limited resource.

Self-discipline starts in the center of your brain, in a place called the ACC (anterior cingulate cortex).

This area of the brain is responsible for a wide range of cognitive functions, from emotional response to rational decision-making. But its most important function is impulse control.

The ACC is the part of your brain that keeps you from running rude drivers off the road; it keeps you from eating the entire bag of BBQ chips during a football game; it keeps you from yelling the same hurtful words at your teenager that they just yelled at you.

Your ACC controls your willpower.

Your brain can seem complicated, but it is really just another biological organ in your body.

And its functions are tied to biological needs.

Your brain works best when it is well nourished and well rested. The same is true for your ACC – one small part of your brain.

The most important factor in building a strong ACC is maintaining regular glucose levels.

Glucose is a simple sugar found in almost all natural foods. It is the most abundant carbohydrate on the planet and you can find it in everything from fruit to pasta.

We are lucky that glucose is abundant because it is the only energy source that fuels cognitive functions in the brain.

As long as your body has healthy glucose levels, your ACC (the source of your willpower) functions effectively. But if your glucose level drops, your ACC suffers.

Low glucose levels weaken your willpower and threaten your self-discipline.

Low blood sugar happens two different ways:

1. When you don't consume enough food to sustain your energy output.
2. When you have a medical condition (ex: diabetes) that negatively impacts your body's ability to process glucose.

When the body has a drop in blood sugar, it reacts by releasing adrenaline (epinephrine) to sustain core physical functions. While the adrenaline can physically sustain the body between meals, it cannot sustain your cognitive functions. Only glucose can do that.

The result is a fully functional body, but a near total lack of willpower.

You will feel normal physically, but your temper is short, your memory fails you, and you struggle to make good decisions.

We all know this feeling. It's the feeling of getting home after a long day at work. Or buying fast-food for dinner because traffic was terrible. Or skipping a workout because you just want a break.

To gain elite self-discipline, maintain healthy glucose levels.

In medical terms, we want blood sugar levels between 80-130 mg/dL (milligrams per deciliter).

In normal human terms, it means we need to eat regular meals and stay hydrated throughout the day.

People think motivation comes before self-discipline. It doesn't.

Self discipline – like eating fruit and drinking water – leads to tangible results. Tangible results create motivation. And once you are motivated to keep going, the road to living the life you want gets faster and easier!

I am committed to giving you elite operational tools that solve everyday problems. I just taught you the concept; now let me teach you the process.

Here is the simple spyHACK elite operators use to master self-discipline:

(1) Powerful Fruit

Fruits are the cleanest, simplest, and most effective form of glucose. At this moment, thousands of special operators around the world are carrying a banana, an apple, or an orange in their ops bag.

Easy to pack, easy to digest, and naturally protected by its own skin/rind, a piece of fruit can sustain your ACC for 4-6 hours after consumption.

(2) Timing is Everything

Your body needs time to digest food, break down complex sugars, and transfer the glucose into your bloodstream. This process takes 1-2 hours after your first bite. For field operators, we consume glucose-rich fruit 3 hours before our planned operational task.

As a dad and business owner, I schedule my afternoon fruit break between 2-3pm. This ensures my ACC is at full performance when I walk in the door after work and face the chaos of multiple children, cooking dinner, and shepherding the bedtime routine.

(3) The Water Advantage

Efficient digestion and blood flow requires water. The body works best when it is hydrated. Unfortunately, 75% of Americans are chronically dehydrated. Dehydration limits glucose transfer to your bloodstream and makes it difficult to know when the glucose will hit your ACC.

Drinking water at the same time that you consume fruit helps ensure proper digestion and glucose transfer. A simple 8oz. glass of water along with a piece of fruit can boost your body's digestion by nearly half.

And here is how you put into daily practice!

When I first revealed this secret to the SpyTribe, I gave them a 'physical discipline' challenge:

1. Commit to eating one piece of fruit (apple, banana, or orange) for the next 4 days, 2-3 hours before you know your willpower will be tested (dealing with children, working out, studying, etc.)
2. Commit to drinking 1 liter of water (2 standard plastic water bottles) over the course of each day for the next 4 days.
3. Write to me and share your reactions to the increased willpower you experience during this timeframe.

These are just some of the amazing results they shared:

"Day 3 of fruit snack and hydration. I'm feeling GREAT!! And I don't get that awful crash around 2/2:30 like I normally do.

I've really been able to hone in on the relationship between my sugar levels and my focus levels. I used to use coffee and working out as ways to "amp" or supercharge my brain. But by the end of the day, I'd be simultaneously exhausted and full of caffeine. By focusing more on hydration and adding a simple fruit snack in during the day, my focus has soared. Strange thing too - probably more to do with hydration - but I'm not as stiff and snap/crackle/pop in the mornings.

It was really interesting to feel the physical discipline affecting the mental discipline." -- Aaron, GA

“Day 6 for me is at an end, and at this point I’m convinced. It works for sure. I I’ve been filling my days with pretty productive stuff with much less downtime than I used to need. I’m starting to strategically consume fruit now.

So what I have noticed about this, I don’t feel like I need as much time to recover from a long week. I’ve pretty much had something scheduled every day after work, and if I didn’t I put something there that needed to be done, like errands/chores or time at the gym. Normally I’d be itching for some recovery time but I feel alright.

I’ve been going to the gym more often, I have definition to my arm muscles again. I ran out of time before I ran out of steam.” -- Tony, NY

“I’ve lost count of how many days I’ve been doing this. But I’m beginning to form a habit. I drink my liter of water without really thinking about it.

It always amazes me that so many people don’t experience how good the body can feel when we just give it what it needs. Some water, some rest, some simple natural sugars and everything starts to come together.” -- Hannah, NC

Your best days are still ahead of you. And I can’t wait to see you win more than you ever imagined when you apply this simple, powerful spy skill!

Godspeed, #EverydaySpy

ABOUT THE AUTHOR *Andrew Bustamante, Founder of EverydaySpy.com, is a former covert CIA Intelligence officer, decorated US Air Force Combat Veteran, and respected Fortune 500 senior advisor. Learn more from Andrew on his Podcast (The Everyday Espionage Podcast) and by following @EverydaySpy on your favorite social media platform.*

